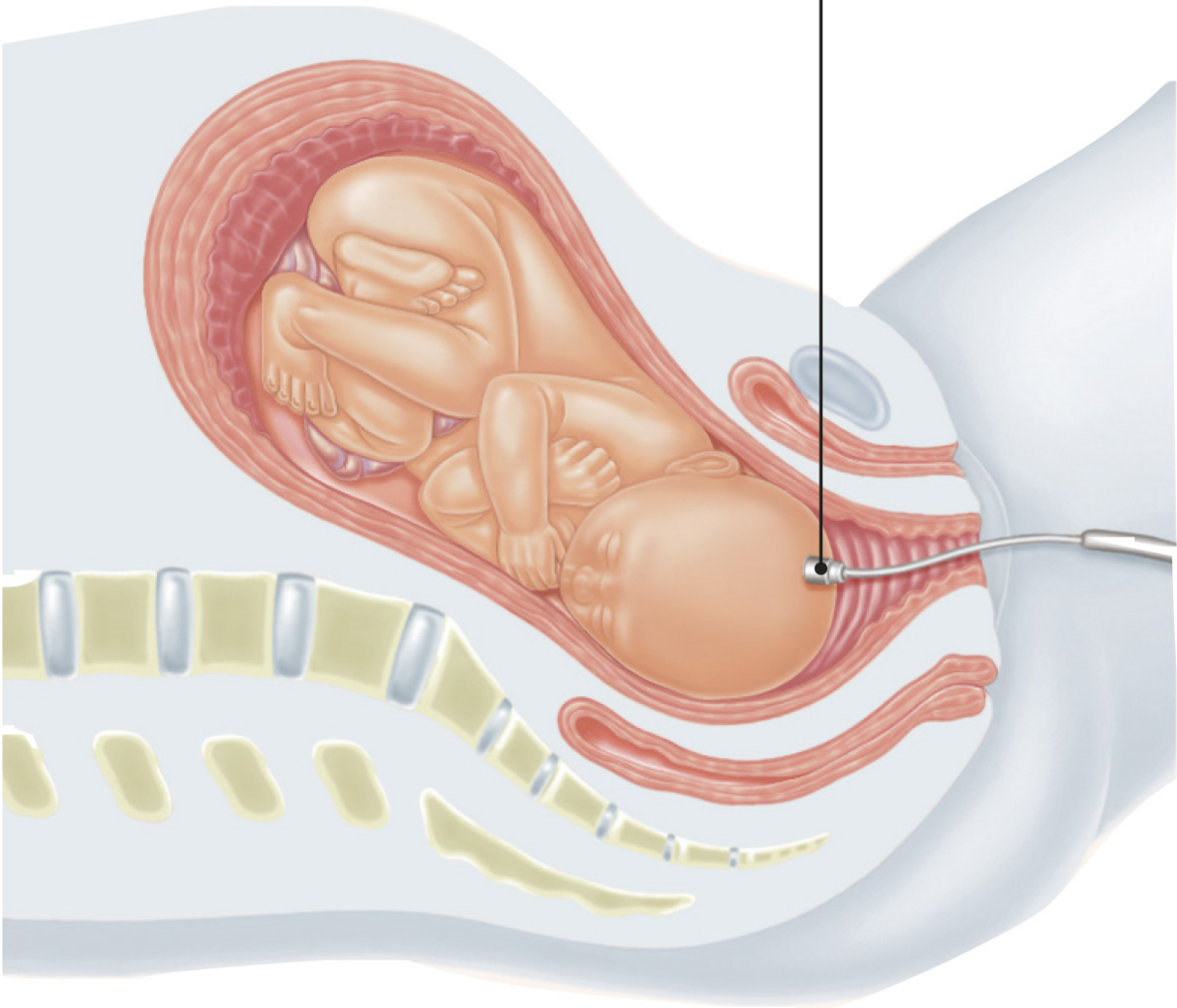


Electrode is attached
to baby's head



SHOULD YOU HAVE ELECTRONIC FETAL MONITORING?

There is some debate as to the benefits of continuous monitoring, and some believe there may be associated maternal risks due to increased interventions.

As a result, you may be offered intermittent fetal monitoring if you have a healthy baby. If you are low risk, the chance of your baby developing a problem in labor is low and can be detected by intermittent auscultation before there is any significant harm.

If the nurse hears an abnormality in the baby's heart rate, or you develop other risk factors such as an infection, or the baby passes meconium, the nurse will suggest that you transfer to continuous monitoring. If you have any complications of pregnancy that suggest that the placenta is not functioning properly, such as inadequate growth or low amniotic fluid, then continuous monitoring is recommended because your baby is more vulnerable to the stress of labor.